

Where you host your website matters just as much as how it's built. For small business and charity sites, I deploy to **Cloudflare Pages** almost every time. Here's why.

Served from the edge, everywhere

Cloudflare has data centres in hundreds of cities worldwide. Your static site is cached at every one of them, so a visitor in Manchester and a visitor in Melbourne both get your pages from a server just down the road. That's the foundation of a genuinely fast experience.

Free, automatic SSL

Every site gets a valid HTTPS certificate automatically, renewed forever, at no cost. Secure by default — no annual certificate fees, no manual renewals to forget.

Enterprise-grade security for free

- **DDoS protection** absorbs traffic floods before they reach your site.
- **A Web Application Firewall** blocks common attacks.
- **Security headers** (which I configure via a `_headers` file) lock down how your site can be embedded and what it's allowed to load.

Brilliant value

Cloudflare's free tier comfortably covers most small business sites — unlimited bandwidth, unlimited requests. As you grow, paid plans stay very affordable.

Built for modern frameworks

Cloudflare Pages connects straight to your Git repository and rebuilds your Astro site on every push. Preview deployments let you review changes before they go live. It's a clean, modern workflow with no server to patch or maintain.

Fast, secure, resilient and cost-effective — Cloudflare ticks every box I care about when I put a client's site into the world.